

DIRECTORY

RULERS AND LEADERS

Whether leadership is achieved through heredity, democracy, or sheer brute force, leaders make decisions that determine how history will judge their time in power. Great leaders have been the salvation of their people, while weak leaders have been responsible for bringing mighty empires to their knees.

EGYPTIAN PHARAOKS

Ancient Egyptian history is divided up into a number of major periods: the Old Kingdom (2649–2150 BCE); the Middle Kingdom (2040–1640 BCE); and the New Kingdom (1550–1070 BCE), with “Intermediate” periods between them and a Late Period (712–332 BCE) at the end. Within these time periods, a large number of dynasties ruled Egypt, from the 1st Dynasty (2920–2880 BCE) even before the Old Period, reaching the 26th Dynasty (672–525 BCE), which ended with Egypt’s conquest by the Persian ruler Cambyses. Aside from a brief period when native Egyptian rulers regained power, Egypt remained part of the Persian Empire until 332 BCE, when it was conquered by Alexander the Great. In 30 BCE, it became part of the Roman Empire.

PERIOD	DYNASTY	NOTABLE PHARAOKS
Early Dynastic Period (3100–2686 BCE)	1st Dynasty (3100–2890 BCE)	Narmer (c.3100 BCE) Menes (c.3000 BCE) Den (c.2950 BCE)
	2nd Dynasty (2890–2686 BCE)	Peribsen (c.2700 BCE)
Old Kingdom (2686–2181 BCE)	3rd Dynasty (2686–2613 BCE)	Djoser (2667–2648 BCE)
	4th Dynasty (2613–2494 BCE)	Snefru (2613–2589 BCE) Khufu (Cheops) (2589–2566 BCE) Menkaure (Mycinerus) (2532–2503 BCE) Shepseskaf (2503–2498 BCE)
	5th Dynasty (2494–2345 BCE)	Userkaf (2494–2487 BCE) Sahure (2487–2475 BCE) Nyuserre (2445–2421 BCE) Djedkare (2414–2375 BCE) Unas (2375–2345 BCE)
	6th Dynasty (2345–2181 BCE)	Teti (2345–2323 BCE) Pepi I (2321–2287 BCE) Merenre (2287–2278 BCE) Pepi II (2278–2184 BCE)
First Intermediate Period (2181–2040 BCE)	7th and 8th Dynasties (2181–2125 BCE)	Numerous ephemeral kings, as central authority collapsed
	9th and 10th Dynasties (at Kerakleopolis) (2160–2025 BCE)	Power struggle between minor rulers of Upper and Lower Egypt
	11th Dynasty (at Thebes) (2125–2040 BCE)	Intef II (2112–2063 BCE)
Middle Kingdom (2040–1650 BCE)	11th Dynasty (all Egypt) (2040–1985 BCE)	Mentuhotep II (2040–2004 BCE) Mentuhotep III (2004–1992 BCE) Mentuhotep IV (1992–1985 BCE)
	12th Dynasty (1985–1795 BCE)	Amenemhet I (1985–1955 BCE) Senwosret I (1965–1920 BCE) Amenemhet II (1922–1878 BCE) Senwosret III (1874–1855 BCE) Amenemhet IV (1808–1799 BCE)
	13th Dynasty (1795–c.1650 BCE)	Minor rulers
	14th Dynasty (c.1750–c.1650 BCE)	Minor rulers
Second Intermediate Period (1650–1550 BCE)	15th Dynasty (Hyksos) (1650–1550 BCE)	Apophis (c.1585–c.1542 BCE)
	16th Dynasty (1650–1550 BCE)	Minor Hyksos rulers contemporary with the 15th Dynasty

PERIOD	DYNASTY	NOTABLE PHARAOKS
New Kingdom (1550–1069 BCE)	17th Dynasty (at Thebes) (1650–1550 BCE)	Kamose (1555–1550 BCE)
	18th Dynasty (1550–1295 BCE)	Ahmose (1550–1525 BCE) Amenhotep I (1525–1504 BCE) Tuthmosis I (1504–1492 BCE) Tuthmosis II (1492–1479 BCE) Tuthmosis III (1479–1425 BCE) Hatshepsut (1473–1458 BCE) Amenhotep II (1427–1400 BCE) Tuthmosis IV (1400–1390 BCE) Amenhotep III (1390–1352 BCE) Amenhotep IV/Akhenaten (c.1352–1336 BCE) Smenkhare (1338–1336 BCE) Tutankhamun (1336–1327 BCE) Ay (1327–1323 BCE) Horemheb (1323–1295 BCE)
	19th Dynasty (1295–1186 BCE)	Ramesses I (1295–1294 BCE) Seti I (1294–1279 BCE) Ramesses II (1279–1213 BCE) Merneptah (1213–1203 BCE)
	20th Dynasty (1186–1070 BCE)	Ramesses III (1184–1153 BCE) Ramesses V (1147–1143 BCE) Ramesses XI (1099–1069 BCE)
Third Intermediate Period (1069–747 BCE)	21st Dynasty (1069–945 BCE)	Smendes (1069–1043 BCE) Psusennes I (1039–991 BCE) Osorkon I (984–978 BCE) Psusennes II (959–945 BCE)
	22nd Dynasty (945–715 BCE)	Shoshenq I (945–924 BCE) Osorkon II (874–850 BCE) Shoshenq III (825–773 BCE) Osorkon V (730–715 BCE)
	23rd Dynasty (c.818–715 BCE) 24th Dynasty (727–715 BCE)	Competing lines of lesser rulers at Hermopolis Magna, Leontopolis, and Tanis
	Late Period (747–332 BCE)	25th Dynasty (Nubia and all of Egypt) (747–656 BCE) Piye (747–716 BCE) Shabaqa (716–702 BCE) Taharqa (690–664 BCE)
	26th Dynasty (664–525 BCE)	Psammetichus I (664–610 BCE) Apries (589–570 BCE) Amasis (570–526 BCE) Psammetichus III (526–525 BCE)

ROMAN EMPERORS

In 27 BCE, Octavian, on becoming Rome’s first emperor, renamed himself Gaius Julius Caesar Augustus. From then on, emperors took the honorific title Augustus for the duration of their reign. Until 286, this was normally a title unique to one person, but there were periods of joint rule, usually when the succession was disputed or the nominated heir was too young to rule alone. However, the emperor Diocletian instigated a different system, the Tetrarchy, under which four individuals ruled the empire, two as Augustus and two as Caesar—a kind of “junior emperor.” This persisted (with some variations) until 395, when the eastern and western portions of the empire split from each other.

NAME	REIGN	NAME	REIGN
Augustus	27 BCE–14 CE	Trajan	98–117
Tiberius	14–37	Hadrian	117–38
Gaius Caligula	37–41	Antoninus Pius	138–61
Claudius	41–54	Marcus Aurelius	161–80
Nero	54–68	Lucius Verus (co-Augustus)	161–69
Galba	68–69	Commodus	180–92
Otho	69	Pertinax	193
Vitellius	69	Didius Julianus	193
Vespasian	69–79	Septimius Severus	193–211
Titus	79–81	Caracalla (co-Augustus 198–211)	198–217
Domitian	81–96	Geta (co-Augustus)	209–11
Nerva	96–98		

